

THE PRINCIPLES OF PSYCHOLOGY

CHAPTER IV – HABIT

When we look at living creatures from an outward point of view, one of the first things that strike us is that they are bundles of habits.

An acquired habit, from the physiological point of view, is nothing but a new pathway of discharge formed in the brain, by which certain incoming currents ever after tend to escape.

The great thing in all education is to make our nervous system our ally instead of our enemy. For this we must make automatic and habitual, as early as possible, as many useful actions as we can.

Habit simplifies the movements required to achieve a given result, makes them more accurate and diminishes fatigue.

There is no more miserable human being than one in whom nothing is habitual but indecision.

Editor's summary for the qualification fixture: James developed the theory of habit formation. The principle of association depends on repetition. The psychologist uses introspection as a method of study. The educator causes the student to form good habits.

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